



Anthropic's \$40B IPO hides

compute decay



The retail *AI windfall* illusion

Retail investors view the targeted **October listing** on Nasdaq as early-stage upside. In reality, private VCs use public markets to offload massive capital expenditure liabilities before inevitable **3.8x margin compression** hits enterprise compute models.



Offloading massive *CapEx liabilities*

Cloud hyperscalers lock in paper multiples while passing infrastructure debt to public equity holders. Buying at listing converts hyper-growth valuation expectations into paying off **billions in compute debt** while early backers exit at peak enterprise pricing.



The institutional *exit liquidity* engine

Late-stage venture funds face severe internal rate of return hurdles. Public retail order flow provides necessary volume for insiders to distribute positions before the post-listing **180-day lockup expiry** triggers structural dilution and aggressive selling pressure.



Quantifying the *valuation decay* rate

Mega-cap tech listings entering with negative free cash flow historically experience a **42% valuation haircut** over 12 months as server depreciation and GPU replenishment costs erode gross margins below sustainable **15% enterprise thresholds**.



The 180-day *execution rule*

Never allocate capital to mega-cap hype listings or correlated proxy baskets during the initial **180-day lock-in period**. Wait until audited post-listing **free cash flow** and unit economics validate long-term operational sustainability.



The 3-point *pre-listing audit*

Before allocating capital, verify: 1) Positive **free cash flow trajectory** net of compute costs; 2) Less than **20% insider distribution** at lockup expiry; and 3) Sustainable enterprise customer retention above **120% net expansion**.



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